



RICHARD'S RIVAL

Edward Alleyn (1566–1626) was the star of the Lord Admiral's Men, and Richard Burbage's only real rival. He made his name playing Marlowe's heroes Dr. Faustus and Tamburlaine. Thomas Nashe wrote that no tragic actor in history "could ever perform more in action than famous Ned Allen."

TRAGIC TRANSFORMATION

Shakespeare wrote his greatest tragic roles for Richard Burbage (1568–1619). Burbage was famous for transforming himself into characters. Writer Richard Flecknoe said Burbage would "take off himself with his clothes," and "never assumed himself again until the play was done."



Work table, where costumes were made and altered to suit new roles

BEHIND THE SCENES

At the modern Globe theater in London, England, a room has been set up to show visitors what a tiring, or dressing, room would have looked like in Shakespeare's day. Costumes, wigs, and props were stored in the tiring room, and it was also the place where some of the costumes would have been made. Between scenes, the players made their hurried costume changes here.



Tireman admiring a new wig

Dress, to be worn by a boy player playing a woman

COSTUME CARE

The tireman was in charge of his company's most valuable property – the costumes. Some of the costumes were bought from London tailors, and some were made by the company. Others were donated or sold to the players by courtiers, who did not like to be seen wearing the same outfit more than once.